



Across the water

Humans have been traveling by water for so long that it is impossible to know exactly when the first boats were built. Some have changed little over the centuries, but today there are also hi-tech speedboats, mighty tankers, and giant cruise liners on the waters of the world.



1768

Captain James Cook sets off from England to explore the South Pacific. His voyage takes three years and covers more than 30,000 miles (48,000 km).

Santa Maria

1492

Explorer Christopher Columbus sails west from Spain in the *Santa Maria*. He crosses the Atlantic Ocean and lands in the Bahamas.

1661

The first recorded yacht race takes place, between the English King Charles II and his brother James, on the Thames River in London.

1500

1600

1700

1510

The English ship *Mary Rose* is one of the first to be built with gunports, holes for cannons to fire through.

1620

The *Mayflower* leaves Plymouth, England, taking 102 pilgrims to settle in the New World (America).



1716

In the early 1700s, the waters of the Caribbean were at their most dangerous, as pirates plundered Spanish treasure ships.



1519

Portuguese navigator Ferdinand Magellan sets out with a fleet of five ships. Just one would make it back in 1522, having completed the first voyage around the world.

Mayflower

